

Internship – Monthly Journal 1

Tasks performed and outcomes

My first four weeks were mainly focused on the learning of Time-Series Forecasting. My first meeting with my supervisor was held on . I got to understand that I will be working on a Customer Product Lifecycle Management (CPLM) project on different portfolios of defined specifications. We will be dealing with data. data is basically a retail sell-out data by an agency. Sell-out data are referred to as products sold through retailers such as . Had discussions with the previous intern on the time-series concepts. We had a briefing on CPLM and Auto Price for Value (PFV) project. Scope of Analysis and feasibility study was covered during the briefing. Concepts such as market mix and back-testing were briefly explained during clarification sessions with my supervisor –

We also had another discussion on portfolio mapping on . I had sent over and shared some of my ideas/suggestions to improve the mapping current process. The following weeks will have certain tasks related to this.

On , my supervisor handed me a task to explore demand forecasting by providing a short briefing session and sharing the relevant datasets.

I have mainly reading up on the various time-series forecasting techniques such as ARIMA, Exponential Smoothing Models etc. by referring to this reference material (<https://otexts.com/fpp2/what-can-be-forecast.html>) and did a datacamp course on 'Forecasting with R'.

Reflections

I do have some concerns on back-testing techniques to perform forecasting. Will have more sessions with my supervisor and do more readings on how to perform back-testing and set the back-testing and forecasting periods.

This has made me realise the importance of self-learning and how it can help to expedite the understanding and application of concepts. It is also important to schedule regular sessions with the supervisor and clarify doubts whenever possible.

Coursework and Reflections

I am grateful for the experience to learn forecasting techniques and most importantly applying them to a business use case. With many challenges in place, I also find myself understanding the different issues when it comes to forecasting and trying to find possible solutions to overcome them. I hope to have a ground understanding of time-series forecasting and improve my creativity and critical-thinking skills by the end of my internships. I also see this opportunity to learn more about the customer analytics work and master my skills in R programming.